

Behavioral Interventions



Precontemplation: Not intending to change in the next 6 months. The focus specific to behavior therapy should be on becoming better informed about factors that affect a healthy lifestyle through use of behavior therapy techniques.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Healthy Education (Premacking)	Choose a healthy living website for your Internet home page.
Articles Everywhere! (Stimulus Control)	Place healthy living magazines in the bathroom, at your desk, and in the living room on your coffee table. (This may need to be done by a person to whom the client is close; try recruiting friends or family members to help scatter magazines.)
Contemplation: Intending to change within the next 6 months. Interventions specific to goal setting should focus on creating goals that will help clients identify benefits of healthy changes specific to them.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Create a Contract 1 (Contingency Contracting)	Create a contract with the client. The contract should have a behavioral goal of identifying several positive effects specific to the client of getting healthy. Reward the client with something he or she will enjoy.
Smoothie Time! (Premacking)	If the client enjoys getting smoothies, require the client to get these beverages only at the local gym instead of a large national chain of juice/smoothie bars. (This intervention may work only if the client has a membership in a gym with a smoothie/juice bar.)
Message Time! (Premacking)	If the client enjoys getting massages, require the client to get massages only at the gym. (This intervention may work only if the client has a membership in a gym with massage services.)
Preparation: Intending to change in the next month. Interventions specific to goal setting should focus on creating goals to help clients prepare for a healthy lifestyle.	
Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Create a Contract 2 (Contingency Contracting)	Focus on setting up the first three phases of a contingency contract (identify target behaviors, determine how progress will be monitored, and specify specific rewards and consequences) for nutrition and/or fitness goals.
Just Say No! (Modeling: Assertiveness Training)	Complete the “Just Say No!” worksheet found in the appendix with the client to practice how the client will say “no” to food temptation from family and friends using the key aspects of assertiveness.
Overcoming Fears (Relaxation Training)	Identify a fear the client has that creates a barrier to achieving the client’s wellness goals (e.g., looking silly at the gym, the rock wall, or the weight area). Provide the client with directions on the three different relaxation techniques and have the client select one of them to use for overcoming the fear.

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Action: Just beginning to change. The focus should be on using behavior therapy techniques that help facilitate healthy behavior change.

Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Create a Contract 3 (Contingency Contracting)	Implement a contingency contract for fitness and nutrition goals.
Take a Walk (Premacking)	Identify an activity the client enjoys that can be paired up with a walk. (Example: If a client enjoys going to a local restaurant, he or she must walk there.)
Ban the Elevator or Escalator! (Premacking)	If the client works on the second or third floor of an office building, ban the individual from taking the elevator or escalator when trying to get to the office. If a client works above the third floor, ban the client from taking the elevator until he or she has walked up at least nine flights of stairs per day.
Your Best Technique (Modeling: Behavioral Coaching)	Use the six steps to behavioral coaching to help a client work on the best technique for a specific exercise.

Maintenance: In the process of change for 6 months. Behavior therapy interventions should focus on helping the client maintain change.

Name of Intervention	Description of Intervention
Group Class (Relaxation Training)	Identify a specific type of exercise that the client has been avoiding and have the client use a type of relaxation training to stop avoiding this type of exercise.
Create a Contract 4 (Contingency Contracting)	Review and update the contract with new goals and rewards.